

HCM

UI/UX Product Standard

Domain Standard #05 · Modern Human Capital Management

Design direction: People Intelligence Platform · Human-centered · Strategic · Personalized · Data-informed

Purpose: Define a reusable UI/UX standard for strategic workforce management: talent, performance, skills, learning, succession, engagement and organizational planning.

Modernity rule: HCM should feel like a modern people-intelligence platform, not simply an expanded employee database.

1. HCM Product Definition

Human Capital Management focuses on the strategic lifecycle of people within an organization. While HRMS emphasizes administration and transactions, HCM emphasizes capability, performance, engagement, workforce planning and organizational outcomes.

Core UX objective: connect employee experience with organizational goals while making people insights understandable and actionable.

Primary user groups

- **Employees:** goals, skills, learning, career development and feedback.
- **Managers:** team performance, capability, engagement and succession.
- **HR/People teams:** talent programs, workforce planning and organizational analytics.
- **Executives:** workforce trends, capability gaps, organizational health and strategic planning.
- **Administrators:** talent frameworks, permissions, workflows and system configuration.

2. Modern HCM Design Language

Style type: People Intelligence / Strategic Workforce Workspace

- **Visual tone:** premium, human, optimistic, trustworthy and analytical.
- **Layout:** editorial-style workforce dashboards combined with structured enterprise data views.
- **Density:** low-to-medium for employee experiences; medium for talent operations; high for analytics.
- **Surfaces:** clean cards, subtle dividers, contextual panels and restrained data visualization.
- **Navigation:** role-aware and task-oriented, with strategic modules separated from administrative workflows.
- **Interaction:** goal tracking, skill exploration, guided reviews, contextual feedback and drill-down analytics.
- **Personalization:** surface content based on employee role, career stage, team and organizational context.

3. Current HCM UI Pattern Expectations

Modern HCM should combine human-centered consumer-grade simplicity with enterprise-grade governance.

Pattern	HCM expectation	Example
Personalized home	Role-aware content and recommended actions.	Employee sees goals, learning and career actions.
People profile	Rich employee capability and career workspace.	Skills + goals + learning + performance + career path.
Goal progress	Visualize objectives and progress.	Quarterly goals with milestones and manager feedback.
Skill graph	Connect skills to roles and development.	Current skills → target skills → recommended learning.
Career pathways	Make growth opportunities discoverable.	Show possible next roles and capability requirements.
Talent matrix	Visualize strategic talent information carefully.	Performance/potential views with appropriate permissions.
Continuous feedback	Move beyond annual-only reviews.	Lightweight feedback and recognition moments.
Workforce analytics	Make trends understandable through contextual data.	Attrition, skills gaps and workforce composition.

Pattern	HCM expectation	Example
AI copilot	Assist with summaries and development suggestions.	Summarize review feedback or suggest learning resources.
Progressive disclosure	Keep sensitive talent data controlled.	Reveal detailed evaluation data only to authorized roles.

4. HCM Information Architecture

- **People:** employee directory, profiles, organizational structure and talent context.
- **Performance:** goals, reviews, feedback and performance cycles.
- **Talent:** potential, succession, talent pools and development plans.
- **Skills:** skill taxonomy, proficiency, skill gaps and role requirements.
- **Learning:** courses, learning paths, certifications and recommendations.
- **Career:** career paths, opportunities, mentoring and development.
- **Engagement:** surveys, recognition, listening and employee sentiment where applicable.
- **Workforce Planning:** headcount plans, capability gaps, organizational scenarios and strategic workforce insights.
- **Analytics:** people metrics, trends and drill-down reporting.
- **Administration:** frameworks, permissions, workflows, policies and integrations.

5. HCM Navigation Standard

Recommended model: Personalized Home → People/Talent Domain → Context → Insight → Action.

- Keep employee navigation simple and development-oriented.
- Separate strategic talent workflows from transactional HR operations.
- Use global people search only within the user's authorization scope.
- Provide quick access to goals, feedback, learning and career actions.
- Maintain consistent global utilities such as notifications, help and profile.
- Use contextual navigation from employee → skills → goals → learning → career.

6. Design System Foundations

Foundation	HCM standard
Grid	12-column desktop grid with flexible dashboard and profile layouts.
Spacing	4px base; 8/12/16/24/32px primary rhythm.
Typography	Highly readable modern sans-serif; emphasize hierarchy and approachable language.
Radius	8–12px for modern cards and surfaces; avoid excessive decorative rounding.
Color	Neutral base + brand accent + carefully defined semantic and talent-status colors.
Visualization	Simple charts, progress indicators and matrices with strong labeling.
Density	Comfortable for employee UX; configurable for expert HR/people analytics.
Motion	Subtle progress, transition and feedback animation only.

7. Employee People Profile

The HCM employee profile should evolve from a static record into a people-development workspace.

- **Identity:** name, role, team, location and organizational context.
- **Career:** current role, career aspirations and potential pathways where applicable.
- **Skills:** verified skills, proficiency and development gaps.
- **Goals:** current objectives, progress and outcomes.
- **Performance:** review history and feedback according to permission.
- **Learning:** current learning path, certifications and recommendations.
- **Recognition:** achievements and peer/manager recognition where supported.
- **Activity:** meaningful development events rather than unnecessary system noise.

8. Performance & Goal UX

- Use continuous goal progress instead of relying only on end-of-cycle review screens.
- Show objective, owner, timeframe, progress and outcome clearly.
- Allow employees and managers to update progress in context.
- Use milestones and progress indicators only when they represent real work.
- Keep feedback connected to goals where useful.
- Make review cycles, deadlines and next actions visible.
- Separate self-assessment, manager assessment and final outcome clearly.

9. Skills & Capability UX

- Represent skills using clear names and proficiency levels.
- Show current capability versus role requirements.
- Make skill gaps actionable rather than merely informational.
- Connect skills to learning recommendations and career pathways.
- Allow users to explore related roles and capabilities.
- Provide transparent definitions for proficiency levels.
- Use visual skill maps carefully; prioritize comprehension over novelty.

10. Learning Experience

- Treat learning as a personalized journey rather than a course catalog.
- Recommend learning based on role, skills and goals where appropriate.
- Show progress, deadlines, certifications and next steps.
- Use cards and progress patterns for discovery; use lists/tables for administrative management.
- Provide strong search and filters for large learning libraries.
- Make completion and certification status clear.

11. Career Development UX

- Show current position and possible development pathways.
- Represent required capabilities for target roles.
- Connect development actions to skills and learning.
- Allow employees to express interests without implying guaranteed promotion.
- Give managers tools to support career conversations.
- Use timeline or milestone patterns for development plans.

12. Talent & Succession UX

Talent information is sensitive and should use explicit permission boundaries and contextual presentation.

- Use talent pools and succession views only for authorized roles.
- Make the criteria behind strategic talent views understandable where policy permits.
- Do not expose sensitive assessments unnecessarily.
- Use filters for role, organization, location and readiness where applicable.
- Provide drill-down from organizational view to authorized individual context.
- Maintain auditability for significant talent decisions.

13. Workforce Intelligence Dashboard

- Surface workforce trends, capability gaps, organizational structure and strategic indicators.
- Combine current state with historical trend where it improves interpretation.
- Allow filtering by organizational context with clear scope labels.
- Use drill-down from metric → segment → employee population.
- Do not overload executives with operational HR details.
- Make data freshness and definitions clear for important metrics.

14. AI & Intelligent HCM Standard

AI can support people development, but HCM interfaces require especially careful handling of sensitive and consequential information.

- Use AI for policy explanation, review summarization, learning recommendations and development assistance where appropriate.
- Clearly distinguish generated suggestions from authoritative HR records.
- Provide source/context for AI-generated policy or workforce insights.
- Require human review for consequential talent, employment or workforce decisions.
- Allow users to correct or reject generated recommendations.
- Respect organizational permissions and privacy boundaries.

15. Example — Performance Review Flow

- **Preparation:** employee reviews goals and gathers achievements.

- **Self-review:** structured reflection connected to goals and outcomes.
- **Manager review:** manager sees relevant goals, feedback and context.
- **Conversation:** discussion and development actions are recorded.
- **Outcome:** final review status and agreed development plan.
- **Follow-up:** goals and learning actions continue into the next cycle.

16. Example — Career Growth Flow

- **Discover:** employee explores possible future roles.
- **Compare:** current skills versus target-role capabilities.
- **Plan:** create development actions and learning goals.
- **Progress:** track skill development and milestones.
- **Review:** manager/employee discuss progress.
- **Next step:** update the development plan based on evidence and organizational opportunities.

17. Accessibility & Inclusive UX

- Target WCAG 2.2 AA.
- Support keyboard navigation and visible focus.
- Do not use color alone for performance, talent or progress states.
- Provide accessible alternatives for matrices, charts and visual skill maps.
- Use inclusive language and avoid unnecessarily judgmental labels.
- Maintain readable typography, contrast and zoom behavior.
- Respect reduced-motion preferences.

18. Responsive Strategy

- **Desktop:** people analytics, talent planning, performance administration and workforce strategy.
- **Tablet:** manager reviews, goals, team insights and development actions.
- **Mobile:** goals, feedback, learning, recognition and career actions.
- Use focused cards and progressive disclosure on small screens.
- Never expose sensitive detail simply because it is technically available on a device.

19. HCM UX Quality Gates

Gate	Validation question
Human clarity	Can employees understand what they should do next?
Strategic value	Does the interface connect people activity to organizational outcomes?
Personalization	Does the experience adapt to role and context without becoming confusing?
Privacy	Are sensitive talent and performance data appropriately protected?
Actionability	Can insights lead directly to a meaningful action?

Gate	Validation question
Trust	Are metrics, assessments and AI suggestions understandable?
Accessibility	Can all core workflows be completed accessibly?
Modernity	Does the experience feel current while remaining professional and usable?

20. Design-Glanza Product Builder Rules

- Generate separate but connected experiences for employee, manager, people team and executive personas.
- Treat Employee Profile, Goal, Skill, Learning Item, Review, Career Path and Talent Pool as reusable objects.
- Generate realistic lifecycle states and permission-restricted states.
- Use current SaaS patterns such as personalized homes, contextual panels, progress views, skill visualization, saved views and responsible AI assistance.
- Do not use gamification or visual trends unless they reinforce a genuine people-development objective.
- Make sensitive information permission-aware by default.
- Audit the generated HCM for privacy, accessibility, consistency, responsiveness and trust.

21. HCM Standard Summary

Style: People Intelligence / Strategic Workforce Workspace

UX model: Discover → Understand → Develop → Act → Reflect → Grow

Visual priority: human context → capability → progress → insight → action

Modern patterns: personalized home, skill graphs, career pathways, continuous feedback, workforce intelligence and responsible AI

Non-negotiables: privacy, human-centered language, accessibility, transparency, permission accuracy and strategic usefulness.

Domain Standard #05 for the Design-Glanza domain library. Organization-specific policies, legal requirements and research may extend this baseline; intentional deviations should be documented.